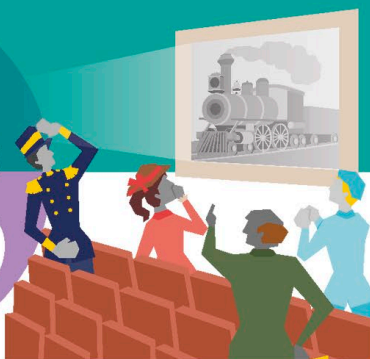


December

28



1895 First picture show

French inventors the Lumière brothers set up the first-ever paid public screening of a film. The Cinématograph, a portable device patented by them, projected nine short films to an amazed audience.

Born this day

1922 Stan Lee, US comic book publisher. He co-created the superheroes Spider-Man, the X-Men, and many more.

1964 Denzel Washington, Black American actor. He has played the lead in many Hollywood thrillers and dramas.

1065

Medieval church

Westminster Abbey, in London, UK, was consecrated. A renovated monastery, it has been the setting of many coronations, and remains a burial place for famous figures – from warriors to poets.



1912 Riding the rails

An estimated 50,000 people turned up to see the first public streetcars, the Municipal Railway No. 1, in San Francisco, USA. These vehicles are now part of the world's last manually operated cable car system.



Also on this day

1612 Neptune was seen for the first time by Italian astronomer Galileo Galilei, who mistook it for a star.

1886 The first automatic dishwasher, which was turned by hand, was patented by US inventor Josephine Cochran.

1973 The United States Endangered Species Act came into force to protect threatened species from becoming extinct.